

Policies & FAQs

Pristine Waters Fly Fishing — Patagonia & Tierra del Fuego

Welcome to Pristine Waters. Please take a moment to read the following information before confirming your reservation. By booking any of our services, guests acknowledge that they have read and accepted the following terms and conditions.

Conservation & Ethics

Pristine Waters believes that fly fishing is closely connected to conservation, scientific knowledge and responsible access to wild places. Our goal is to provide memorable experiences while promoting respect for rivers, wildlife, local communities and Patagonia's natural heritage.

We encourage all guests to follow the principles of ethical angling, including:

- Respect for wildlife and surrounding habitats.
- Careful handling of fish.
- Responsible access to public and private land.
- Respect for local regulations.
- Leave No Trace principles.

Catch & Release Policy

All Pristine Waters fishing programs operate under a strict catch-and-release policy. Whenever possible, we encourage anglers to:

- Minimize handling time.
- Keep fish in the water whenever possible.
- Wet their hands before handling fish.
- Minimize air exposure.
- Avoid unnecessary stress to the fish.

Our commitment is to help preserve these fisheries for future generations.

Introduced Species

Patagonia's rivers and lakes are home to several introduced species, including brown trout, brook trout and Pacific salmon. These species have become part of the region's ecological, cultural, scientific and recreational landscape and continue to be the subject of ongoing scientific research and management efforts.

Pristine Waters supports a science-based approach to conservation and encourages responsible stewardship of aquatic ecosystems.

Booking Policy

Reservations are confirmed once the required payment has been received and acknowledged by Pristine Waters. All bookings are subject to availability.

Guests will receive written confirmation of their reservation, together with a summary of the services included in their experience.

Payment Policy

Full-day trips

Full payment is required to confirm the reservation.

Multi-day trips

A 30% deposit is required to secure the reservation. The remaining balance must be paid no later than 90 days before the start of the trip.

Payments may be made by bank transfer or through a secure online payment link. Any transfer fees, bank charges or exchange costs are the responsibility of the guest.

Cancellation Policy

Full-day trips

Full-day trips are non-refundable. Whenever possible, Pristine Waters will make reasonable efforts to accommodate a change of date, subject to availability. Reservations may also be transferred to another guest for the same date.

Multi-day trips

More than 90 days before departure: deposits may be transferred to another date, subject to availability.

Within 90 days of departure: deposits and final payments are non-refundable. Reservations may be transferred to another guest if a suitable replacement is provided.

Weather Policy

Weather conditions are an essential part of the Patagonian experience. Pristine Waters reserves the right to modify locations, schedules, access routes, fishing methods and itineraries whenever necessary to ensure the safety of guests and guides. Whenever possible, an alternative plan will be proposed.

Fishing Conditions

Fly fishing success cannot be guaranteed. River conditions, weather, water levels, temperatures, fish behavior and other environmental factors are beyond our control.

Force Majeure

Pristine Waters shall not be held responsible for circumstances beyond its control, including but not limited to severe weather conditions, road closures, border restrictions, strikes, fires, floods, accidents, civil disturbances, government regulations, and natural disasters.

Travel Insurance

We strongly recommend that all guests obtain adequate travel insurance covering medical expenses, trip cancellation, trip interruption, flight delays, baggage loss, personal liability, and outdoor activities, including fly fishing.

Safety

All guests will receive a safety briefing before the beginning of their trip. Fishing in Patagonia frequently involves driving long distances, walking over uneven terrain, wading in rivers and being exposed to rapidly changing weather conditions. Guests participate at their own risk.

Equipment

Pristine Waters can provide equipment whenever required, including rods, reels, fly lines, waders and boots. Guests are also welcome to bring their own equipment.

Photography

Photographs and videos taken during our trips may be used on our website, social media platforms and other marketing materials. Guests who prefer not to appear in photographs or videos should notify us before the beginning of their experience.

Privacy Policy

Pristine Waters respects your privacy. Personal information shared with us will be used exclusively for operational, logistical and communication purposes. We will never sell or disclose personal information to third parties unless required by law.

Applicable Law

All services provided by Pristine Waters are governed by the laws of the Republic of Chile. Any disputes shall be subject to the jurisdiction of the Chilean courts.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need previous fly-fishing experience?

No. Beginners and experienced anglers are welcome.

Is all equipment included?

Yes. We can provide all the necessary equipment if required.

Are fishing licences included?

Yes.

Are meals and beverages included?

Yes, unless otherwise specified.

Are park entrance fees included?

No.

Can non-anglers join the trip?

Please contact us to discuss the available options.

Can trips be customized?

Absolutely. We can tailor an experience according to your schedule, interests and experience level.

Do you practice catch and release?

Yes. All Pristine Waters fishing experiences operate under a strict catch-and-release policy.

What happens if the weather changes?

Patagonian weather changes quickly. Our guides will always select the safest and most suitable option according to the prevailing conditions.

Can you help us with transportation and logistics?

Yes. We are always happy to help our guests make the most of their time in Patagonia.